A-A-54555
15 December 1991

# COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

## SPONGE, LAPAROTOMY

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description as a replacement for Federal Specification DDD-P-46D which is cancelled.

Salient Characteristics:

Shall be nonsterile, radiopaque, 4 ply, gauze laparotomy sponges (abdominal packs) suitable for use in surgery. Laparotomy sponges shall be reusable, shall withstand numerous washings and shall be capable of being autoclaved.

Laparotomy sponges shall be of the following sizes.

Dimensions of finished Laparotomy Sponges

| Size | Minimum dimensions for individual sponge (inches) | | | Average minimum dimensions for 1 dozen or more sponges (inches) | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | 3-1/2 | x | 17 | 3-3/4 | x | 17-1/2 |
| 2 | 7 | x | 34 | 7-1/2 | x | 35 |
| 3 | 11 | x | 10 | 11-1/2 | x | 11 |
| 4 | 17 | x | 16 | 17-1/2 | x | 17 |

Laparotomy sponges shall be four plies of bleached gauze meeting all requirements of type III Absorbent Gauze, USP. Sponges shall be securely sewn along all four edges joining all four plies together. There shall be no exposed raw edges and no open pockets. Where edges are folded in to prevent raw edges, the edges shall be folded in approximately 1/2 inch. Edge stitches shall be a nominal 1/4 inch from the edges of the sponge. The sponges shall be divided into a number of rectangular sections, "U" sections or squares by means of suitable transverse seams, or transverse and longitudional seams. Thread breaks and ends of seams and stitches shall be backstitched or backtacked not less than 1/2 inch. Thread breaks in lines of stitches are permitted when they cross a border line of stitches or when the end of the line of stitches meets a border line of stitches at an angle. There shall be not more than 2 such stitch line breaks per sponge. The finished sponge shall show no tendency to bunch or migrate.

AMSC\NA FSC 6510

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:35Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Stitch shall be type 301 in accordance with Federal Standard No. 751. The minimum number of stitches per inch shall be six.

The ends of a tape loop and a radiopaque tab insert shall be securely stitched between layers of gauze at one corner of the sponges. The tape loop shall be 3/8 inch minimum width, bleached white cotton herringbone twill or plain weave. As an alternate to white, the tape loops may be colored. Dyed tape loops shall have at least good colorfastness to laundering when tested in accordance with method 5610 of Federal Test Method Standard No. 191. Dyed loops shall not bleed when autoclaved and shall be nontoxic. The tape loop shall extend at least 5-1/2 inches from the sponge.

The radiopaque tab shall be flexible, inert and nontoxic. The radiopaque tab shall be fabricated of a plastic material and shall be impregnated with an inert nontoxic substance which is opaque to x-rays. The radiopaque tab shall be capable of withstanding sterilization by live steam at a temperature of 250°F for one hour without bleeding or becoming tacky. For sizes 1,2, and 3 the radiopaque tab shall be a minimum of 1-1/4 inches long by a minimum of 5/16 inch wide. For size 4, the radiopaque tab shall be a minimum of 3-1/2 inches long by a minimum of 5/16 inch wide.

Laparotomy sponges shall be free of holes, cuts, tears, loose threads, ravelings, foreign matter and puckering.

Workmanship. The Laparotomy Sponges shall be free from defects which detract from their appearance or impair their serviceability.

Unit. Package (PG). One package containing 100 laparotomy sponges of one size only, as specified, constitutes one unit.

Quality Assurance Provisions.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:35Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

Sampling for examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and as specified herein. Unit of product for examination purposes shall be one sponge. Sampling shall be Inspection level II with an acceptable quality level (AQL) of 2.5 (percent defective).

Examination. Examination shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements.

Sampling for tests. Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and as specified herein. Unit of product for test purposes shall be one sponge. Sampling shall be Inspection level S-1 with an AQL of 2.5 (percent defective).

Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements. Where feasible, the same sample shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description and conforms to the producers' own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Metric Products. Products manufactured to metric dimensions will be considered on an equal basis with those manufactured using inch-pound units, providing they fall within the tolerance specified using conversion tables contained in the latest revision of Federal Standard No. 376, and all other requirements of this document are met.



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:35Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

If a product is manufactured to metric dimensions and those dimensions exceed the tolerance specified in the inch/pound units, a request should be made to the contracting officer to determine if the product is acceptable.

The contracting officer has the option of accepting or rejecting the product.

Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Federal Acquisition Regulation Subpart 23.4 to the maximum extent practical.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging, and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

**NOTE:** The following National Stock Numbers are covered by this document:

| NSN | ITEM IDENTIFICATION | SIZE |
|---|---|---|
| 6510-00-202-8000 | SPONGE, LAPAROTOMY, RADIOPAQUE, 4 by 18 inches, 100s | 1 |
| 6510-00-202-8530 | SPONGE, LAPAROTOMY, RADIOPAQUE, 8 by 36 inches, 100s | 2 |
| 6510-00-202-8555 | SPONGE, LAPAROTOMY, RADIOPAQUE, 12 by 12 inches, 100s | 3 |
| 6510-00-559-3173 | SPONGE, LAPAROTOMY, RADIOPAQUE, 18 by 18 inches, 100s | 4 |



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:35Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Ordering data. Intermediate/exterior package quantities and labeling and marking must be specified in the contract and/or order.

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

PREPARING ACTIVITY:
DoD - MB

Agent:

DLA-DM

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITY:

VA-OSS
PHS
FDA-MPQAS

PGC 05085

Project No. 6510-0813



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:35Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

# STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

## INSTRUCTIONS

1. The preparing activity must complete blocks 1, 2, 3, and 8. In block 1, both the document number and revision letter should be given.
2. The submitter of this form must complete blocks 4, 5, 6, and 7.
3. The preparing activity must provide a reply within 30 days from receipt of the form.

NOTE: This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, or clarification of requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements.

| I RECOMMEND A CHANGE: | 1. DOCUMENT NUMBER | 2. DOCUMENT DATE (YYMMDD) |
|---|---|---|
| | A-A-54555 | 15 DECEMBER 1991 |

3. DOCUMENT TITLE
SPONGE, LAPAROTOMY

4. NATURE OF CHANGE (Identify paragraph number and include proposed rewrite, if possible. Attach extra sheets as needed.)

5. REASON FOR RECOMMENDATION

| 6. SUBMITTER | | |
|---|---|---|
| a. NAME (Last, First, Middle Initial) | b. ORGANIZATION | |
| c. ADDRESS (Include Zip Code) | d. TELEPHONE (Include Area Code)<br>(1) Commercial<br>(2) AUTOVON (If applicable) | 7. DATE SUBMITTED (YYMMDD) |

| 8. PREPARING ACTIVITY | | |
|---|---|---|
| a. NAME<br>Defense Personnel Support Center | b. TELEPHONE (Include Area Code)<br>(1) Commercial<br>(215)737-2870 | (2) AUTOVON<br>444-2870 |
| c. ADDRESS (Include Zip Code)<br>ATTN: DPSC-MSE<br>2800 S. 20th Street<br>Philadelphia, PA 19101 | IF YOU DO NOT RECEIVE A REPLY WITHIN 45 DAYS, CONTACT:<br>Defense Quality and Standardization Office<br>5203 Leesburg Pike, Suite 1403, Falls Church, VA 22041-3466<br>Telephone (703) 756-2340 AUTOVON 289-2340 | |

DD Form 1426, OCT 89 — Previous editions are obsolete. — 198/290

Source: https://assist.dla.mil - Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:35Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.